

Momentum Companion Roadmap

Build the brain first. Let the companion become the face later.

Decision: Do Not Merge Yet

The cleanest path is to keep building the bot as its own proof-of-concept instead of forcing it into the main productivity app too early. The Momentum Bot should become the brain: task tracking, XP, history, patterns, insights, rules, and automation. The Companion should become the face: conversation, encouragement, emotional check-ins, and questions.

When the brain is strong enough, we can either merge it into the main app or keep building this into the new main app until it naturally replaces the older structure.

High-Level Architecture Goal

Layer	Purpose	Why it matters
Momentum Brain	Rules, history, XP, streaks, task data, patterns, insights.	Keeps answers factual and fast without needing AI for everything.
Companion Layer	Chat, emotional support, reflection, coaching, question answering.	Only tags in when personality or interpretation is useful.
Context Bridge	Small summary file like companion_context.json.	Lets the companion read the bot brain without needing to understand the full app.
Future Interface	Voice, 2D avatar, overlay, or main app integration.	Cosmetic features become powerful only after the brain is smart.

Recommended Phases From Here

Phase	Build	Goal	Test / Done When
2A	Insights Tab	Show strongest habit, weakest habit, completion rate, trend detection, and generated observations.	Opening the tab gives useful pattern notes without asking the AI.
2B	Dynamic Observations	Detect repeated misses, anchors, recovery patterns, and inactive streak risks.	Bot says things like: Coding has been missed 3 sessions in a row.
2C	Momentum State Evolution	Expand states: Danger Zone, Recovery Mode, Rebuild Mode, Stable Momentum, Momentum Rising, Locked In.	State changes based on real history, not vibes.
3	Companion Context Generator	Create companion_context.json with current state, streaks, strongest/weakest habits, recent misses, next move.	File updates after Finish the List or Refresh Brain.
4	Companion Uses Context	The chat companion reads companion_context.json instead of raw history.	Follow-up questions feel personal, fast, and grounded.

Phase	Build	Goal	Test / Done When
5	Decision Point: Merge or Continue	Choose whether to merge into the main productivity app or let this become the new base app.	Merging feels boring, not scary.
6	Voice	Add ElevenLabs or local TTS after the brain is useful.	Voice speaks real insights, not generic motivation.
7	2D Avatar / Overlay	Add visual personality last.	Avatar reacts to real task state and momentum data.

Why This Order Makes the Project Easier

Merging now would tangle two different jobs together: the existing productivity app handles actions and tracking, while the companion proof-of-concept is teaching us how the bot should think and talk. By building the brain first, the companion can later sit on top of a clean data summary instead of being hardwired into every feature.

The key move is the context bridge. Once companion_context.json exists, any interface can use it: Tkinter chat, main app panel, voice, overlay, avatar, or a future redesigned app.

Phase 3 Context File - Target Shape

```
{
  "momentum_state": "Recovery Mode",
  "current_streak": 2,
  "strongest_habit": "Complete Workout",
  "weakest_habit": "Coding Core Task",
  "recent_missed": ["Coding Core Task", "Networking / LinkedIn"],
  "recommended_move": "Code for 10 minutes only.",
  "risk_note": "Inactive stretch detected recently.",
  "last_updated": "YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM"
}
```

Next Build Session Recommendation

Build Phase 2A: Insights Tab. This gives the biggest wow factor next because it lets the bot notice patterns instead of only answering questions. Keep it rule-based first. No Ollama required.

Checklist
Add an Insights button or tab.
Show strongest habit and weakest habit.
Show recent completion percentage.
Show repeated misses over the last 7-14 days.
Show one recommended move.
Keep outputs short, direct, and data-grounded.

Decision Rule for Merging Later

Do not merge until the companion can reliably answer: What did I complete? What did I miss? What is slipping? What should I do next? Why is that the recommended move? Once those are stable, merging becomes a design choice instead of a rescue mission.

Bottom line: keep building the bot until it has the intelligence and automation pieces you wanted from Product 2. Then either merge cleanly or let this become the new main app.